

TempusFugit

Tempus Fugit (Time Flies)

Configuration & Setup Guide

1. Pack Overview

TempusFugit is a carefully curated solo survival modpack built on NeoForge 1.21.1, with Sinytra Connector providing support for select Fabric mods. Designed around a philosophy where the world tells a story through geography rather than quest text. The surface is beautiful but dangerous, caves escalate in dread the deeper you venture, and structures are rare enough that finding one feels like a genuine discovery.

Core Design Pillars

- The Living World: terrain, creatures, structures, seasons
- Resources & Economy: ores, materials, villager trading, farming
- Survival & Progression: tools, weapons, armor, enchanting, food
- Danger & Combat: mob spawning, difficulty, boss encounters, death consequences
- Experience & Immersion: visuals, audio, UI, performance

The Danger Ladder

The world escalates in danger from surface to deep underground; each zone distinct, each with its own threats:

- Surface: Animal predators, mythological creatures and tribal civilizations inhabit the world day and night
- Dark Forests: Dense canopy blocks sunlight even at midday, allowing monsters to spawn freely within. These ancient woods are beautiful but genuinely dangerous.
- Cave Entrance: Vanilla monsters emerging from below mark the threshold between relative safety and active danger
- Mid Cave: Vanilla monsters and cave systems require preparation and caution
- Deep Cave: Tier 4-5 Ice & Fire Dragons
- Nether: A hostile amplified underworld
- End: Nullscape's vast alien desolation

2. Technical Specifications

Setting	Value
Java Version	Java 21 required
Mod Loader	NeoForge 1.21.1 + Sinytra Connector
Primary Launcher	CurseForge
World Seed	TempusFugit (recommended only)
Play Style	Solo Survival or small LAN server (recommended only)
Shaders	Complementary Unbound r5.8.1 or Photon 1.3b (recommended and optional)
Minimum RAM	4GB to 8GB (8GB recommended for best performance)

3. World Generation Stack

Terrain & Biomes

- Tectonic: primary terrain shaper, dramatic mountain ranges and underground rivers
- William Wythers Overhauled Overworld (WOOO): biome enrichment using only vanilla biome IDs, no new biomes added
- Lithostitched: world generation compatibility layer
- Amplified Nether: enhanced Nether generation
- Nullscape: End dimension overhaul, desolate and vast
- Serene Seasons + Serene Seasons Plus: seasonal changes throughout the year

Datapack Load Order

Maintained automatically via Paxi's datapack_load_order.json (no need to edit in game). WOOO must remain highest priority to ensure correct biome generation over Tectonic. Listed from lowest to highest priority:

- workshop_for_handsome_adventurer_server2
- workshop_for_handsome_adventurer_server
- vanilla
- mod/explorify
- mod_data
- fabric
- supplementaries:generated_pack
- tectonic
- everycomp:dynamic_resources
- potion_ring_recipe.zip
- William Wythers Overhauled Overworld (highest priority, always above Tectonic)

Structure Philosophy

Global structure spacing is set to 2.25x vanilla through Structurify, making structures rare and meaningful. Key individual overrides:

- Fire Dragon Roosts: 4x spacing, restricted to Desert, Windswept Savanna and Badlands only. Surface dragon encounters are extremely rare; elder dragons prefer the solitude of deep dark caves, however young fire dragons are occasionally known to seek the warmest surface biomes to roost and prey upon local wildlife.
- Ocean Villages (Tidal Towns): 6x spacing, very rare ocean discoveries
- Galleons (Supplementaries): 6x spacing, extremely rare ocean encounters
- Ocean Monuments: halved frequency via individual override

4. Progression Systems

Tool & Weapon Progression

TempusFugit uses a natural survival progression path centered on exploration and creature encounters. The ultimate goal is defeating Ice & Fire's most powerful dragons to forge Dragonsteel, the pinnacle of weapons & armor.

Tier	Path	Gate
Flint Tools	Entry level crafting, some wooden tools disabled or weak	Starting point
Stone	Vanilla stone tools, require stone instead of cobblestone; reduced durability	Mine stone with flint tools
Copper	Ice & Fire copper tools and armor, smelted in vanilla furnace	Mine copper ore with stone tools
Iron	Hephaestus Smeltery, requires copper components and lava	Find iron ingots via loot or trade to build the smeltery controller
Diamond	Vanilla crafting + loot / trade	Exploration and trade
Netherite	Vanilla upgrade path	Nether survival
Dragonsteel	Ice & Fire crafting	Defeat tier 4-5 dragon

Key Progression Notes

- Punch a tree? What is this Minecraft?
- Some wooden tools are disabled; flint tools serve as an entry point for crafting.
- Ore reduction: all ores spawn at 50% vanilla rates, making resources feel meaningful and earned
- Only Hammers and Excavators: adds 3x1 area mining tools for stone and dirt type blocks. Wooden and stone variants are disabled; higher-tier versions become available starting in the Iron Age.
- Hephaestus Smeltery: build to produce iron ingots. Iron ore, deepslate iron ore and raw iron will only smelt to a single nugget in a furnace or blast furnace.
- Tool Belt: provides a dedicated belt slot via the Curios system for quick tool access
- Amethyst Shards: serve as the enchanting reroll catalyst for Easy Magic

Enchanting & Anvil

Easy Magic and Easy Anvils enhance the vanilla systems without replacing them:

- Easy Magic: items stay in the enchanting table, full enchantment preview, reroll enchantments using Amethyst Shards as catalyst at a small XP cost
- Easy Anvils: no “too-expensive” limit, halved book enchantment costs, name tags craftable, prior work penalty limited and manageable

- Fixed Villager Trades: prevents librarian farming exploits, keeping enchanted books as genuine discoveries

Flight Progression

- Mid game: Hippogryph (tameable via Ice & Fire), earned through world interaction
- Late game: Elytra, gated behind End survival and Nullscape's dramatic terrain

Magical Artifacts

- Just Potion Rings: found in End City, Desert Pyramid and Woodland Mansion loot, or crafted via anvil + potion effect book
- Base ring recipe: Quartz Block + 4 Gold Ingots, Nether gated (via datapack override)

5. Surface Danger Ecosystem

The surface threat has not been removed, it has been redesigned. Vanilla monster hordes have been replaced with a curated ecology of natural predators and mythological creatures that inhabit the world day and night. The surface feels alive rather than artificially dangerous.

Dark forests deserve special mention. Their dense canopy blocks sunlight even at midday, allowing monsters to spawn freely within. These ancient woods are beautiful but genuinely dangerous.

Vanilla Surface Exemptions

- Slimes: swamps and underground, moon cycle dependent
- Witches: wander at night across all biomes, solitary and dangerous but rare
- Husks: desert nights

Ice & Fire Surface Creatures

- Cyclops, Gorgon, Siren, Sea Serpent, Hippocampus
- Hippogryph, Stymphalian Bird (an aerial threat)
- Death Worm: desert only
- Hydra, Pixie, Troll
- All Dread creatures

Animal Garden Predators

- Savanna / Desert / Jungle: Lion, White Rhino, Western Gorilla, Spotted Hyena
- Ocean / River / Swamp: Bull Shark, Alligator Gar, Crocodile, Hippo, Narwhal
- Frozen: Snow Leopard

Mowzie's Mobs

- Frostmaw: frozen biome apex predator
- Umvuthana + Umvuthi: tribal savanna civilization with their own society and territory

- Ferrous Wroughtnaut: underground chamber guardian

6. Configuration Changes

The following configurations have been intentionally modified from their defaults. Changes can be made via config file or in-game via the mod menu where available. All other configs remain at default.

Non-Folder Configs

Config File	Changes Made
betterdays-common.toml	clearWeatherOnWake = false
Butchery.toml	Farmers Delight = true
easyanvils-common.toml	name_tag_crafting_recipe = true
easymagic-server.toml	dedicated_reroll_catalyst = true, enchantment_hint = ALL
fowlplay.json5	penguinSpawnWeight = 0 (Waddles used instead due to mod spawn error)
gravestone-server.toml	friendlyGhost = false
mowziesmobs-client.toml	play_boss_music = false, hide_player_anims_in_first_person = true
mowziesmobs-common.toml	Sculptor generation_distance = -1, Grottol / Lantern / Naga / Foliaath / Bluff / Elokosa spawn disabled
onlyhammersandexcavators-common.toml	DurabilityWoodenHammer = 1, aligns with Wooden Tools Are Dumb mod (flint is the intended entry point)
soundcontroller.json	Animal Garden and Fowl Play sounds reduced to 25% individually per animal
structurify.json	Global spacing 2.25x, multiple structures configured, see Section 3
waystones-common.toml	chunksBetweenWildWaystones = 76, spawnInVillages = FREQUENT, XP costs off, cooldowns on, no inventory button, pets don't teleport, JourneyMap integration on
wooden_tools_are_dumb config	Difficulty set to Easy, removes wooden tool crafting, flint tools required as entry point
workshop_for_handsome_adventurer-common.toml	Chests are renamed for free = true

Folder Configs

Config Folder	Changes Made
incontrol	Amphithere and Cockatrice surface spawning disabled
ore_generation_configuration	global.json: default_keep_chance = 0.5 means 50% ore reduction globally. ores.json: all frontier rules neutralized to keep_chance = 1.0
paxi/datapacks	potion_ring_recipe.zip: Quartz Block replaces Lapis Block in base ring recipe. easymagic_reroll_catalyst.zip: Amethyst Shard as reroll catalyst. WWOO datapack and datapack_load_order.json for automatic load ordering. iaf_copper_pick_stone_tier_datapack.zip: Overrides the Ice and Fire copper pickaxe recipe to apply stone-tier mining behavior. Copper pickaxe cannot harvest diamond-tier blocks. Must be crafted to take effect.
PeacefulSurface_Rules	DefaultRule.json: vanilla monster surface spawning suppressed with curated exemptions: slime, witch, husk and Ice & Fire surface creatures
stormiespiders	can_crawl_on_ceiling = true
iceandfire	iaf-common.json: generate.skeletons = false
structurify	Global spacing 2.25x: fire dragon roosts restricted to desert / badlands / windswept savanna at 4x individual spacing. Monastery disabled. Galleons 6x. Ocean villages 6x. Ocean monuments halved. Explorify structures curated.
scripts (CraftTweaker)	copper_durability.zs: Ice & Fire copper tool durability balanced via ZenScript. iron_nugget_smelting.zs: iron ore, deepslate iron ore and raw iron produce nuggets in furnace and blast furnace, gating iron ingot production behind the Hephaestus Smeltery. stone_tool_recipes.zs: vanilla stone tool recipes now require stone instead of cobblestone. early_hammers_excavators.zs: wooden and stone hammer/excavator recipes removed from Only Hammers and Excavators.

7. In-Game Configuration Changes

The following changes were made via in-game configuration menus. All settings can be adjusted via config file or in-game via the mod menu where available.

Structurify

- Global spacing modifier: 2.25x
- Fire Dragon Roosts: spacing 88 / separation 36, restricted to Desert / Windswept Savanna / Badlands
- Mowzie's Monastery: disabled
- Nullscape Dragon Skeleton: atmospheric landmark, left enabled
- Butchery Vindicator Butcher's House: disabled
- Supplementaries Galleons: spacing 276 / separation 168 (6x vanilla)
- Tidal Towns ocean villages: spacing 306 / separation 72 (6x vanilla)
- Ocean Monuments: spacing doubled for both vanilla and YUNG's Better variants
- Explorify: Supply Cache, Mausoleum and Plains Watchtower disabled. Tavern restricted to open biomes

Complementary Unbound Shader r5.8.1 (Optional but Recommended)

A pre-configured settings file included with the modpack will be applied automatically when the shader is enabled in-game.

- Generated normals: ON, adds subtle depth to all blocks without a resource pack. Strength can be adjusted in shader settings in-game or cycled off entirely if not wanted
- All other settings tuned to personal preference: adjust via the shader options menu
- Alternatively, Photon 1.3b is also Voxy compatible, and a higher FPS option if desired

8. First Time World Setup

Follow these steps in order when creating a new TempusFugit world.

World Creation

Chunk pre-generation and Voxy setup can take a significant amount of time. Starting in Creative mode with frozen time and weather allows the world to remain untouched until your adventure is ready to begin.

1. Select: Creative mode when creating the world, or use `/gamemode creative` after creation; this prevents survival consequences during setup
2. Select: More > Game Rules > World Updates > set Update Fire to OFF
(recommended; fire dragons can otherwise ignite and destroy just about everything)
3. Freeze time: `/gamerule doDaylightCycle false`
4. Freeze weather: `/gamerule doWeatherCycle false`

Chunky Pre-Generation

5. Set radius: `/chunky radius 256c` (recommended) or `/chunky radius 512c` (highly recommended, although it requires significantly more time to complete)
6. Start generation: `/chunky start`
7. Generation can be interrupted with `/chunky pause` and resumed with `/chunky continue`

Note: Pre-load a large area to fully appreciate the vast world created by Tectonic world generation and visible via Voxy.

Voxy LOD Setup

8. Run: `/voxy import current`
9. Voxy LOD render distance by default is set to 512 chunks in Voxy settings
10. Set Minecraft render distance, recommended 12-16 chunks in Video Settings
11. Do a full 360-degree rotation to populate the initial LOD view (if nearby chunks show terrain issues, temporarily set Minecraft render distance to maximum, repeat the 360 rotation, then return to your previous setting)
12. Re-enable time: `/gamerule doDaylightCycle true`
13. Re-enable weather: `/gamerule doWeatherCycle true`
14. **Switch back to Survival:** `/gamemode survival`

9. Pack Distribution

TempusFugit is distributed via CurseForge:

<https://www.curseforge.com/minecraft/modpacks/tempusfugit>

Install directly through the CurseForge App. All mods, configs, scripts, datapacks, and included shader packs install automatically with no manual steps required.

10. Compatibility Notes

Incompatibility	Details
Chisels & Bits	Incompatible with this modpack, the game will not load with Chisels & Bits installed. Do not add it.
Ice & Fire config	Ice & Fire's own config file is unreliable for spawn and structure changes. Use InControl and Structurify for all Ice & Fire spawn and structure control.
Sodium 0.6.13 (do not update)	Sodium is pinned to a specific version for stability. Updating Sodium to alpha or newer versions will break Iris and Reese's Sodium Options. Do not update.
Supplementaries 3.6.7	Supplementaries is pinned at 3.6.7 due to Sodium 0.6.13 fluid renderer compatibility issues in newer Supplementaries versions. Do not update.

TempusFugit was designed with solo survival play in mind; and configured with a single player experience as the primary consideration. Settings may need adjustment for multiplayer or lower-end hardware, but as is would probably play well on a small LAN server with a friend or two.

The seed TempusFugit is only recommended and not required; it produces the spectacular views seen in the GitHub banner pic, and is a great starting point.

For questions or issues regarding the modpack, leave a comment in the Issues or Discussions sections here on GitHub; only refer to the individual mod pages for information and instructions specific to that mod.